

Beacon AI

Cross-border trend intelligence for Indian venture capital. Spot what's working in China and the US before it lands in India.

Mudit Airan · Capstone, Round 1 · 31 Aug 2026

"Funds spend all day underwriting AI companies, then run their own operations without it. That contradiction is the whole subject."

Tommaso Maria Ricci, AI for Venture Capital (2026)

Great models reach India late. Beacon closes the gap.

India's 200+ micro-VCs are relationship-driven, cost-sensitive, and priced out of Western platforms. Winning categories appear first in the US and China, then transfer to India on a lag. Beacon turns that lag into weekly transfer-probability briefs.

200+

active Indian micro-VCs, mostly \$10-40M funds

12-36 mo

typical lag before a US or China model reaches India

\$1.58B

VC software market by 2030, ~11% CAGR

In practice: China's surplus and near-expiry food platforms (Haoshiqi, HotMaxx) scaled into a multi-billion-yuan category. Catching that formation early is proprietary deal flow.

Every wave reached India on a lag. GenAI is arriving now.

TECHNOLOGY WAVE	US PEAK FUNDING	CHINA PEAK FUNDING	INDIA PEAK FUNDING	US TO INDIA LAG	CHINA TO INDIA LAG
E-commerce / Consumer Internet	2010-2012	2014-2015	2016-2018	~6 years	~2 years
Fintech (payments / lending)	2013-2014	2015-2017	2018-2020	~6 years	~2 years
B2B SaaS / enterprise tech	2015-2018	2018-2019	2020-2022	~5 years	~2 years
EV / new-energy auto	2015-2017	2018-2020	2022-2024	~7 years	~3 years
Generative AI / foundation models	2022-2023	2024-2025	2025-2026 (now)	~3 years	~1 year

China to India lag is consistently shorter (~1 to 3 years) than US to India (~3 to 7). The China signal is the earlier, sharper lead. Directional, from funding-round datasets and public timelines.

[Explore the interactive dashboard \(Tableau\)](#)

Sources and data

1 Market sizing

Research and Markets / The Business Research Company, VC Management Software Market Report 2026 (\$0.93B to \$1.58B, ~11% CAGR).

2 Buyer landscape

IVCA and Tracxn estimates for Indian micro-VC counts and fund sizes, early 2026; India 2025 funding ~\$10.5 to 11B.

3 Funding datasets (Kaggle)

Global Startup Funding Rounds 2020-2026; Global VC Trends 2015-2026; Indian Startup Funding 2010-2026; AI Company & Startup Funding Database.

4 Signal proxies

Public news, Google Trends, patent, keyword search trends and hiring signals where available.

Week 1 MVP, beta in three weeks

Week 1	MVP Ingest public funding data, cluster emerging US and China categories, score transfer probability, generate the first brief end to end.	Build
Weeks 2-3	Beta launch Ship the weekly trend brief to 3-5 Indian micro-VCs, add Signals integration, and gather feedback to tighten the scoring.	Ship
Week 4+	Validate Track whether funds act on the briefs; use the signal to decide whether to raise and go full time.	Validate
Cash to build	Founders unpaid. LLM compute ~\$1.5K, data & enrichment ~\$0.8K, cloud infra ~\$0.5K, misc ~\$0.2K. Public funding datasets are free.	~\$3K
If you cost the time	Same three-week scope, plus 1 to 2 builders part-time valued at early-stage rates (~\$17K of time).	~\$20K

Estimates. ~\$3K out-of-pocket to prove the signal before any raise, or ~\$20K if you put a price on the founder time. No third-party market-data licences, so data cost stays near zero.

Big upside on a tiny bet, with eyes open on risk

UPSIDE

Cheap to build, many ways to ship

~\$3K to a working MVP. After beta, the same engine ships as an MCP server, an API, and a Telegram or WhatsApp chatbot: near-zero marginal cost to reach 200+ funds where they already work. Proprietary transfer data compounds into a moat.

RISK

The signal may not convert to alpha

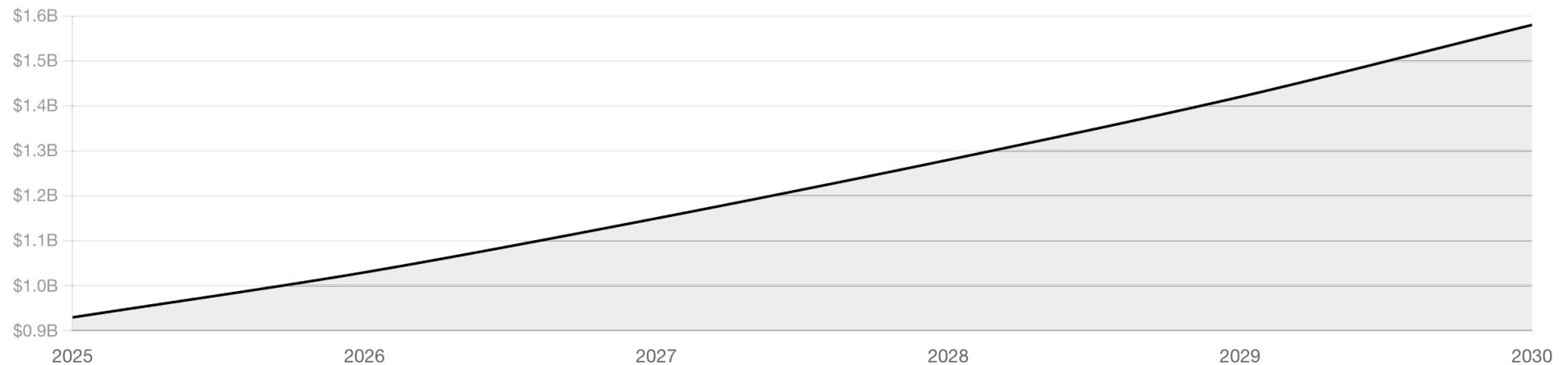
Cross-border mapping is noisy, micro-VCs are cost-sensitive and slow to adopt, and a widely-seen trend stops being an edge. Mitigate: price low, prove briefs drive real deals, own the timestamped data.

APPENDIX

Reference

Market context and supporting data.

A real, growing category: \$0.93B today to \$1.58B by 2030



VC-specific software spend, 2025 actual through 2030 projection at ~11.1% CAGR (Research and Markets / The Business Research Company). A billion-dollar category doubling by 2030 is a good business; it is not, by itself, the tens-of-billions TAM VCs demand, which is why VC is Beacon's beachhead, not its ceiling.

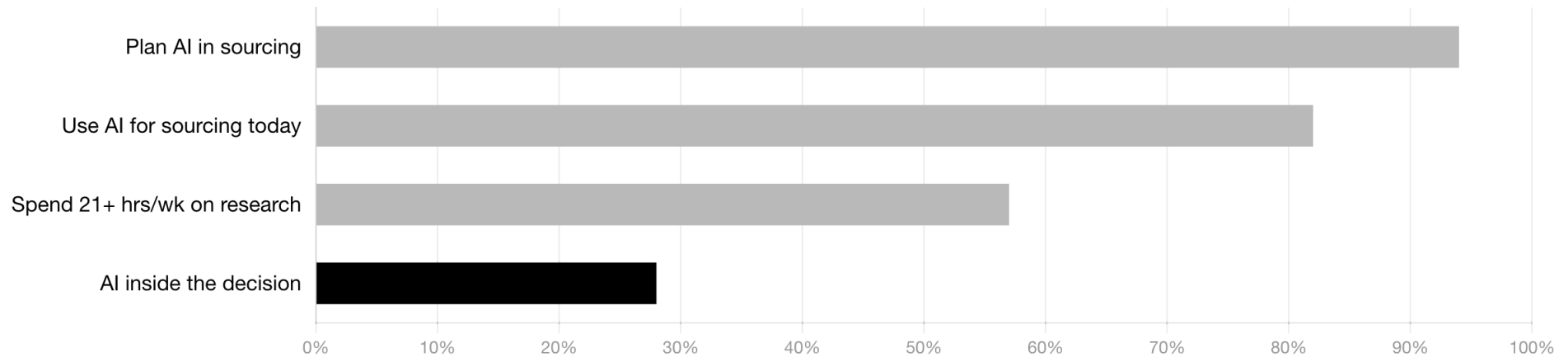
Research and Markets, VC Management Software Market Report 2026

13% → 28%

Share of private-capital firms using AI
inside the investment decision itself,
doubled in a single year (Affinity, 2026).

Affinity, 2026 Private Capital Predictions

AI is moving from add-on to decision layer



Share of surveyed private-capital firms adopting AI across the investment workflow. Sourcing AI is becoming table stakes; the contested frontier is AI inside the memo and the decision (Affinity, 2026).

Affinity, 2026 Private Capital Predictions